

In `next-intl`, the `NEXT_LOCALE` cookie is typically handled automatically by the middleware to persist the user's language preference. [next-intl +1](#)

To update this cookie from the middleware, you can wrap the `next-intl` middleware and manually set the cookie on the resulting response object. [🔗](#)

1. Update Cookie in Middleware [🔗](#)

You can intercept the response from `createMiddleware` and use the `response.cookies.set()` method to update the value or its properties (like `maxAge`). [🔗](#)

typescript



```
// middleware.ts
import createMiddleware from 'next-intl/middleware';
import { NextRequest } from 'next/server';
import { routing } from './i18n/routing';

const intlMiddleware = createMiddleware(routing);

export default function middleware(request: NextRequest) {
  const response = intlMiddleware(request);

  // Example: Force update the NEXT_LOCALE cookie based on custom logic
  // This is useful if you want to set a custom expiration or
  // synchronize it with a user profile setting.
  const locale = 'fr'; // Your resolved locale
  response.cookies.set('NEXT_LOCALE', locale, {
    path: '/',
    maxAge: 60 * 60 * 24 * 30, // 30 days
    sameSite: 'lax',
  });

  return response;
}

export const config = {
  // Match all pathnames except for specialized Next.js files
  matcher: ['/(?!api|_next|_vercel|.*\\.\\.\\.)*.*']
};
```

2. Recommended Configuration

Instead of manual updates, `next-intl` (version 3.0+) allows you to configure cookie behavior directly in your routing settings. [GitHub +1](#)

- **Cookie Expiration:** By default, `NEXT_LOCALE` is a session cookie. You can make it persistent using `localeCookie` in `defineRouting`.
- **Automatic Updates:** The middleware automatically updates the cookie whenever a user visits a route with a different locale prefix (e.g., navigating from `/en` to `/de`). [next-intl +3](#)

Key Considerations

- **Middleware Execution:** The middleware runs for every request that matches your `config.matcher`. Ensure your logic doesn't inadvertently overwrite a user's intentional language switch.
- **Client-Side Switching:** For standard language switchers, it is often better to use the [navigation APIs](#) (like `Link` or `useRouter`) from `next-intl`. These automatically handle the cookie update and redirection without requiring custom middleware code.
- **Cookie Name:** The default cookie name is `NEXT_LOCALE`. While some versions allow customization, most standard implementations rely on this specific key for automatic detection. [GitHub +5](#)